

Possessives (Complete)

Possessive Adjectives and Pronouns in
American English



Recap: Family Members, Family Tree, and Possessives 'My/Mine, Your/Yours'

- In Lesson 5, we described relatives using words like **mother, father, brother, and sister**.
- We learned that **my** and **your** must go before a noun: *"This is my brother. Is that your coffee?"*
- We used **mine** and **yours** when no noun follows: *"The notebook is mine. This phone is yours."*

Quick Check: Which sentence is correct: "Where is mine car?" or "Where is my car?"

Quick Recap Check

Choose the correct sentence to review Lesson 5:

1. This is my bag, and that jacket is yours.

2. That car is your, not my.

3. Where is mine keys on the table?

4. This is mine bag, and that jacket is your.

Quick Recap Check

Choose the correct sentence to review Lesson 5:



1. This is my bag, and that jacket is yours.

2. That car is your, not my.

3. Where is mine keys on the table?

4. This is mine bag, and that jacket is your.

Who Owns This Object?

Imagine you are working in an office in Bogotá. You find a leather bag, a blue planner, and a smartphone on a meeting table.

How do you explain who owns them when you speak about a male coworker, a female manager, or a whole team?

Today we master possessive words for all people!



Learning Objectives

Objectives

1

Use **his, her, its, our, and their** correctly before nouns to talk about family and belongings.

2

Use **his, hers, ours, and theirs** alone without a noun to identify owners with confidence.

3

Ask and answer questions with "**Whose...?**" in realistic adult conversations and role-plays.

Key Vocabulary

Key words



His

Belonging to a man or male person (su / sus de él).



Her

Belonging to a woman or female person (su / sus de ella).



Our

Belonging to us, including the speaker (nuestro / nuestra / nuestros).



Their

Belonging to two or more other people (su / sus de ellos o ellas).

Possessive Adjectives Overview

CORE RULE

Always Place Before a Noun

A possessive adjective describes who owns or has a relationship to something. In English, it **always comes immediately before the noun.**

- **He → His:** *"This is his car."*
- **She → Her:** *"Her brother lives in Cali."*
- **We → Our:** *"This is our company."*
- **They → Their:** *"Those are their keys."*



Subject Pronoun to Possessive Adjective

Possessive adjectives match the **owner**, not the object:

I → My: my father

You → Your: your sister

He → His: his book

She → Her: her phone

It → Its: its color

We → Our: our home

They → Their: their office



Owner Gender: His vs. Her



His (+ noun)

Use **his** when the owner is a man or boy:

*"Carlos is an engineer. **His** car is red. **His** sister is Elena."*



Her (+ noun)

Use **her** when the owner is a woman or girl:

*"Sofia is a doctor. **Her** clinic is in Medellín. **Her** phone is new."*

Avoid the Spanish False Friend: Su / Sus



Common Mistake

In Spanish, "su" can mean his, her, their, or your. In English, you **MUST** identify the exact owner!

In Spanish, people say "*su carro*" whether it belongs to Juan, María, or plural owners.

In English:

- Belongs to Juan → **His** car
- Belongs to María → **Her** car
- Belongs to Carlos & Luisa → **Their** car

Also: English possessives never take an "s" for plural objects! Say "*his cars*", never "*hises cars*".



Choose the Possessive Adjective

Look at the context: "Mario is an engineer. _____ office is in Bogotá."

1.

Its

2.

Her

3.

Their

4.

His

Choose the Possessive Adjective

Look at the context: "Mario is an engineer. _____ office is in Bogotá."



1.

Its

2.

Her

3.

Their

4.

His



Possessive Pronouns Stand Alone

KEY CONCEPT

No Noun After a Possessive Pronoun

A possessive pronoun replaces the possessive adjective AND the noun. It avoids repetitive sentences.

- *"This is my book." → "This book is **mine**."*
- *"This is her desk." → "This desk is **hers**."*
- *"That is our project." → "That project is **ours**."*
- *"These are their keys." → "These keys are **theirs**."*



Possessive Adjective vs. Pronoun



Adjective + Noun

Her pen is blue.

Our office is big.

Their bags are here.



Pronoun Alone

The blue pen is **hers**.

The big office is **ours**.

Those bags are **theirs**.



'His' Does Both!

Adjective: "*This is **his** car.*"

Pronoun: "*This car is **his**.*"

Notice that "his" does not change!



'Its' Has No Pronoun

Adjective: "*The dog ate **its** food.*"

Pronoun: English does not use "its" as a standalone pronoun.

Transforming Adjectives into Pronouns



1. Her → Hers

"This is her book."

Move object first:

"This book is hers."

2. Our → Ours

"This is our office."

Move object first:

"This office is ours."

3. Their → Theirs

"Those are their keys."

Move object first:

"Those keys are theirs."

Match Adjectives to Pronouns

Match the words with the definitions

our

theirs

my

ours

their

mine

her

hers

Match Adjectives to Pronouns

Match the words with the definitions



our

my

their

her

A

theirs

B

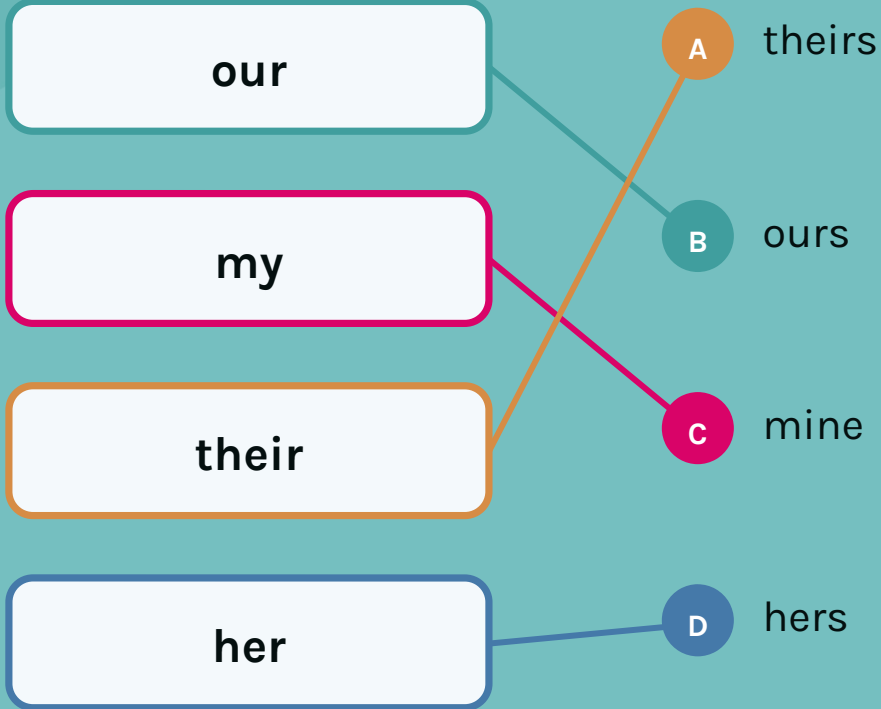
ours

C

mine

D

hers



Watch: Possessives in Daily Life

Watch this video to hear native speakers talk about personal items using possessive adjectives and pronouns.



Listening: Lost and Found

Listen to the audio and answer the questions



Conversation at the Community Center

 **Play audio**

- 1 Whose backpack is the blue one on the chair?
- 2 What color is Elena's backpack?
- 3 Is the green umbrella Elena and Mateo's?
- 4 Whose umbrella is the green one?

Listening: Lost and Found

Check your answers below



Conversation at the Community Center

 **Play audio**

1

It is Carlos's (his).

2

Her backpack is black.

3

No, it is not ours (it is theirs).

4

It is Sofia and David's (theirs).

Asking with "Whose...?"

Question Patterns

To ask about possession, begin with
Whose:

- **Singular object:** *"Whose phone is this?"*→ Answer: *"It is **hers**."* or *"It is **his**."*
- **Plural objects:** *"Whose keys are these?"*→ Answer: *"They are **theirs**."* or *"They are **ours**."*

Notice: We say *"It is hers"* (singular) and *"They are theirs"* (plural).



Whose vs. Who's: Crucial Distinction



Remember

They sound identical, but their grammar and spelling are completely different!



Whose (Possession)

Asks: who is the owner?

*"**Whose** wallet is this? It is **his**."*



Who's = Who is

Contraction of **Who + is**:

*"**Who's** that woman? She is our new teacher."*

Grammar Accuracy Check

In the sentence "That laptop is hers car", the grammar is correct.



TRUE



FALSE



Be ready to explain your thinking.

Grammar Accuracy Check



In the sentence "That laptop is hers car", the grammar is correct.



TRUE



FALSE



 Why is that?

"Hers" is a possessive pronoun and cannot be followed by a noun; say "her car" or "That car is hers".

Describing People and Belongings

In English introductions, combine family relationships with possessives smoothly:



*"This is Carolina. **Her** brother's name is Pedro. **His** car is parked outside, and this coffee is **hers**."*

Master Summary Chart

Compare all forms learned
across Sessions 5 and 6 at a
glance.



Subject

Adjective (+ noun)

Pronoun (no noun)

I / You

my / your

mine / yours

He / She

his / her

his / hers

It

its

— (none)

We / They

our / their



Partner Speaking Workshop

Practice asking about objects and people in pairs.

"Whose phone is this? It's hers. What is her name? Her name is Sofia."

Pair Speaking Practice



With a partner, point to two objects or a family photo and ask: 1. "Whose [object] is this?" 2. "What is his/her name?" Answer using possessive adjectives and pronouns.

Pair Speaking Practice



You might have said...

Example 1: Whose notebook is this? – It is hers. Her name is Laura.

Example 2: Whose keys are these? – They are his. His name is Pedro.

Example 3: That car is ours, and their office is next door.

Self-Check: "I Can..." Statements

Reflect on your learning today. Check off what you can do:

☒ I **can** use *his, her, its, our, and their* before a noun to describe family and belongings.

☒ I **can** use *his, hers, ours, and theirs* without a noun to state ownership.

☒ I **can** ask "*Whose... is this?*" and answer accurately in conversation.

Check Your Understanding



Question 1:

Complete with the adjective: "Ana is a teacher. _____ school is in Cali."

Question 2:

Transform using a possessive pronoun: "This is our office." -> "This office is _____."

Question 3:

Choose the correct word: "Whose keys are these? - They are _____ (their / theirs)."

Check Your Understanding



Answer 1:

Her

Answer 2:

ours

Answer 3:

theirs